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January 10, 1978
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. UU-P-556J
November 20, 1972

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAPER, TOILET TISSUE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification UU-P-556J, dated November 20, 1972.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers single and two-ply toilet tissue in roll form, and sheet tissue.

1.2 Classification. Toilet tissue paper covered by this specification shall be of the following types, grades, and fold, as specified (see 6.1).

Type I - Roll tissue.

Grade A - Two-ply sheets.
Grade B - Single-ply sheets.

Type II - Sheet tissue.

Double fold, 4-1/2 by 5-1/2 inches.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 8540

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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards:

T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 404 - Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 432 - Water Absorption of Bibulous Paper.
T 452 - Brightness of Paper and Paperboard.
T 498 - Softness of Sanitary Tissues.

(Application for copies may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Toilet tissue shall be white, unglazed tissue made from fibrous material. The material offered shall contain not less than 50 percent of recovered materials. Recovered materials are defined as material which has been collected or recovered from solid waste. Solid waste is defined as any garbage, refuse, sludge from a waste treatment plant, water supply treatment plant, or air pollution control facility and other discarded material, including solid, liquid, semisolid, or contained gaseous material resulting from industrial, commercial, mining, and agricultural operations, and from community activities, but does not include solid or dissolved material in domestic sewage, or solid or dissolved materials in irrigation return flows or industrial discharges.

3.2 Type I, roll tissue.

3.2.1 Physical requirements. Roll tissue shall be of single-ply (grade B) or double-ply (grade A) construction as specified (see 6.1) and shall conform to the applicable requirements shown in table I, when tested as specified in 4.4.2. The stated requirements for grade A tissue are for a two-ply sheet.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Characteristics	Type I Grade A	Type I Grade B	Type II
Basis weight, 24 x 36 - 500, minimum, pounds	19	12	10
Tensile strength, dry, oz./inch, MD, minimum	11.2	11.2	11.2
Absorption time of 0.01 ml of water, maximum, seconds	30	40	300
Brightness, minimum, percent	73	68	68
Softness value, grams, maximum each direction	12 1/	15 1/	15 1/

1/ No single set value shall exceed the average by more than 5 grams.

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3.2.2 Roll construction. Roll tissue shall be evenly and tightly wound on a stiff round paperboard core having an inside diameter of 1-3/8 to 1-3/4 inches, sufficiently rigid to prevent collapse under ordinary conditions of transportation and usage. The width of the rolls shall be 4-1/2 + 1/8 inches. Roll tissue shall be perforated as specified in the subparagraphs below. The tissue shall be so perforated that the sheets can be cleanly and completely separated.

3.2.2.1 Grade A, two-ply tissue. Grade A roll tissue shall be perforated at not less than 4-3/8 nor more than 4-5/8 inch intervals, shall average not less than 500 double-ply sheets per roll and no single roll shall contain less than 488 sheets.

3.2.2.2 Grade B, single-ply tissue. Grade B roll tissue shall be perforated at not less than 4-1/4 inch nor more than 4-5/8 inch intervals and shall average not less than 4,500 inches per roll (1000 sheets perforated at 4-1/2 inch intervals or 1,060 sheets perforated at 4-1/4 inches). No single roll shall be less than 4,375 inches in length.

3.3 Type II, sheet tissue.

3.3.1 Physical requirements. The sheet tissue shall conform to the applicable requirements in table I, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.3.2 Assembly of sheets. Double-fold sheet tissue shall be assembled in stacks averaging not less than 800 sheets per package, with not less than 780 sheets in any given package. The sheets shall be so interlocked that two sheets at a time will dispense satisfactory from a container. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/8 inch will be allowed in the length and width of sheet tissue. The sheet size shall be 4-1/2 by 5-1/2 inches.

3.4 Cleanliness. All types of toilet tissue shall be clean and free from dirt spots, holes, or tears 1/16 inch or larger, or more than 5 dirt spots, holes, or tears less than 1/16 inch in one sheet; shives or slivers 1/8 inch or more in length, or more than 5 shives or slivers less than 1/8 inch in length in one sheet; any foreign matter, undigested paper, or unbleached waste.

3.5 Workmanship. Toilet tissue in accordance with this specification shall be uniform in color, and trimmed with clean smooth edges.

3.6 Formation. Sheet formation shall be uniform. Clumps of undisbursed fibers, or thin looking areas, are evidence of poor formation.

3.7 Standard sample. A standard sample shall be furnished with the contract or purchase order and deliveries shall compare favorably with it with respect to formation, workmanship, and cleanliness.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3 Certification. A certificate shall be submitted with each bid specifying the percentage of recovered material to be used in the manufacturer of the items offered to the Government.

4.4 Inspection of the end item.

4.4.1 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be made for the defects set forth in the applicable subparagraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) specified.

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4.4.1.1 Examination for defects in appearance and workmanship. The sample unit shall be ten consecutive sheets selected at random from one roll or package of sheets, as applicable.

The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 6.5 defects per hundred units (dhu) for major defects, and an AQL of 10.0 dhu for major and minor defects combined.

Examine		Defects
Appearance	Major	Not grade specified, applicable to rolls. Formation not uniform. Hard or glazed finish.
Color	Major	Not white, not uniform.
Cleanliness	Major	Any hole, dirt spot or tear 1/16 inch or larger in any dimension. Any shive or sliver 1/8 inch or more in length.
	Minor	More than 5 dirt spots, holes or tears less than 1/16 inch in one sheet. More than 5 shives or slivers less than 1/8 inch in one sheet.
Workmanship:		
Type I	Major	One-half inch or more of a perforation missing between sheets. Sheets separated 1/2 inch or more at the perforation. Sheets cannot be easily separated at the perforation.
	Minor	Perforations not perpendicular to edge of sheet; perforations wavy. Ragged, uneven edges.
Type II	Major	Not double-fold, as specified.

4.4.1.2 Examination for dimensional defects. The sample unit shall be one sheet randomly selected from a roll or unit package. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective.

Examine	Defects
Type I:	
Width of sheet	Greater than 4-5/8 inches or less than 4-3/8 inches.
Length of sheets (distance between perforations)	
Grade A	Less than 4-3/8 or more than 4-5/8 inches.
Grade B	Less than 4-1/4 or more than 4-5/8 inches.
Type II:	
Width of sheets	Varies more than ± 1/8 inch.
Length of sheet	Varies more than ± 1/8 inch.

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4.4.1.3 Examination for defects in construction. The sample unit shall be one roll or package, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective.

Examine	Defects
Type I	Presence of glue or adhesive spots on roll (do not count end of roll if it is glued to prevent unrolling). Roll not evenly or tightly wound. Core not paperboard. Core inside diameter exceeds 1-3/4 inches or is less than 1-3/8 inches. Cores crushed or broken so they cannot conveniently be inserted in dispensers.
Type II:	
Double-fold	Sheets not interlocked in such a manner that two sheets at a time will dispense satisfactorily from a dispenser.

4.4.1.4 Examination for length or count. The sample unit shall be one roll or unit package of sheets as applicable. The lot shall be unacceptable if the average length per roll or number of sheets per package is less than specified. The lot acceptability for defects in the specified length or count of individual rolls or packages shall be determined using inspection level S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective.

4.4.1.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. The sample unit shall be one shipping container or unit load, as applicable. An examination shall be made to determine conformance with the weight and dimensions (unit load), marking, materials, workmanship, and content requirements of section 5.

The inspection level and AQL shall be S-4 and 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.2 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested for applicable characteristics in table II. The methods of testing shall be in accordance with the referenced TAPPI test procedures except where otherwise indicated. The sample unit shall be one roll or unit package, as applicable. The inspection level and AQL shall be S-1 and 2.5 percent defective. The values for each sample unit shall be compared with the applicable requirements of table I.

TABLE II. Testing of the end item

Characteristic	Specification reference	
	Requirement	Test Method 1/
Basis weight (24 x 36 - 500)	Table I	T 410
Tensile strength, dry	Table I	T 404
Absorption time of 0.01 ml of water	Table I	T 432
Brightness	Table I	T 452
Softness value	Table I	T 498 2/

1/ Test methods preceded by the letter "T" are TAPPI test methods.
2/ Specimens prepared from type II tissue for testing in the cross direction shall be cut to eliminate the folds from the sheets.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Each roll or stack of sheets shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's normal commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or Commercial as specified.

5.2.1 Level A. Rolls or sheets, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and water-proof sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Commercial. Rolls or sheets, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard box in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete pack shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage, to insure safe delivery at destination, to provide for safe redistribution by the initial receiving activity and be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Unitization. When shipments to Government depots are full car or truckload, the shipping containers shall be unitized for shipment and handling in accordance with normal commercial practice. The unitized load shall not exceed 2,500 pounds in weight, 63 inches in height, 56 inches in length, and 45 inches in width.

5.4 Marking. Shipping containers and unitized loads (when applicable) shall be marked as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, grade, and fold required, if applicable (see 1.2).
(c) Applicable level of packing (see 5.2).
(d) Marking required (see 5.4).

6.2 The Department of Defense has waived coordination of this specification.

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